

Writing your first grant application

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A little bit about me

- PhD in Engineering at the University of Cambridge looking at quantifying uncertainty.
- Postdoc and fellowship at Imperial College London developing novel methods for outbreak response.
- Member of ICL Ebola and COVID-19 response team
- Senior Lecturer in Statistics at University of Bristol
- Passionate about capacity building!

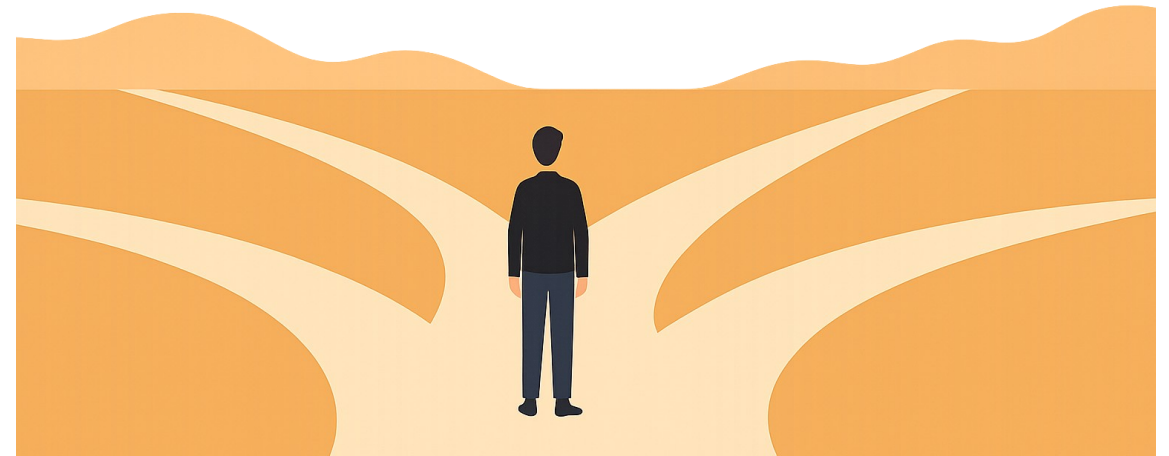


Sorry in advance that it's a
bit UK specific....

There might be other funders e.g. in USA that you might
be eligible for that I don't know

Why apply for funding?

- To undertake a research project
- To explore / develop new collaboration
- To get training



UK funding landscape



BILL & MELINDA
GATES *foundation*

NIHR | National Institute for
Health and Care Research



UK Research
and Innovation



Science and
Technology
Facilities Council



Arts and
Humanities
Research Council



Engineering and
Physical Sciences
Research Council



Biotechnology and
Biological Sciences
Research Council



Economic
and Social
Research Council



Research
England



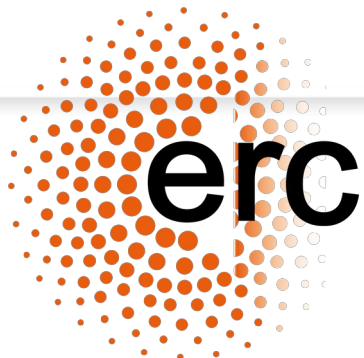
Natural
Environment
Research Council



Innovate
UK



Medical
Research
Council



Selecting the call

- Every scheme is different – want to find the right scheme for what you are trying to do.
- Want to start thinking about grant ideas around 3-6 months before you apply to make sure you can put in a competitive application.
- Schemes can have quite complex eligibility requirements so make sure you read all the guidance.
- You need to check who can apply for the call and make sure you have the necessary collaborators.

Grants

- UoB AI for health
<https://uob.sharepoint.com/sites/elizabeth-blackwell/SitePages/funding.aspx>
- Royal Society travel grant
<https://royalsociety.org/grants/international-exchanges/>
- London Mathematics Society
<https://www.lms.ac.uk/grants/mathematics-in-africa>
- NIHR global health themed
<https://www.nihr.ac.uk/global-health/funding-programmes/ghr-themed>
- Horizon Europe
- Wellcome discovery
<https://wellcome.org/research-funding/schemes/wellcome-discovery-awards>

Application

Your science

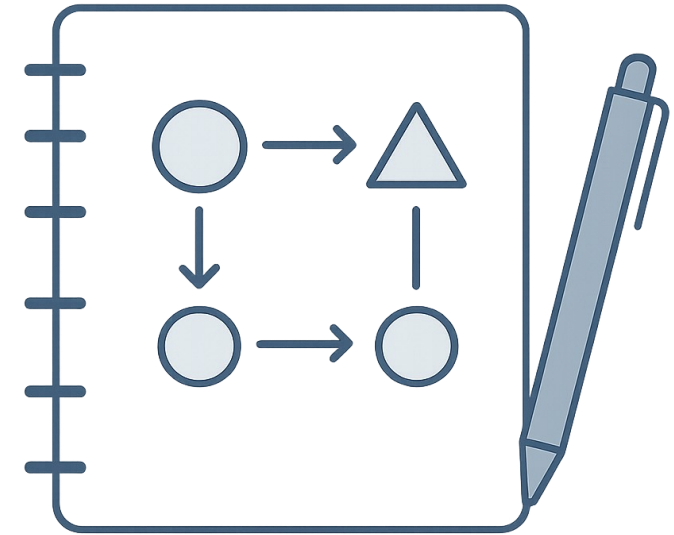
Your opportunity to communicate your science to the review panel.

How technical it should be, again, depends on the scheme.

How much detail depends a lot on the scheme.

- ERC starting grant 19 pages in total about science, some 4 pages

Good to structure your proposal logically.



CV

Two formats now: A traditional one or a narrative CV.

Some like a narrative of how team have worked together / evidence out working together already.

UKRI R4RI modules

Module 1 - Contributions to the generation of new ideas, tools, methodologies or knowledge

Module 2 - The development of others and maintenance of effective working relationships

Module 3 - Contributions to the wider research and innovation community

Module 4 - Contributions to broader research/innovation-users and audiences and towards wider societal benefit



Letters of support

It is helpful to partner with organisations / individuals to support your applications.

Main idea is they write letters of support

- Guidance will tell you what sort of support letters they want
- UKRI project partners are supposed to give you something.

Mentors / Advisory Board

Give you guidance sometimes technical, sometimes professional development.

Name people but don't need official support letters.

Data management plan / Research Ethics

We work with human data a lot of the time.

Often have to write data management plans about how we will store / manage data. There are sometimes templates for this.

Often also have to write information about ethics. Don't always need approval in place already but a plan on how to apply is necessary.

Universities often have teams of people who can help you with this.

Finance

You will most of the time be expected to submit costings for your application: Staff costs, equipment, travel...

Very clear guidance on what can and can't be costed.

Usually need external help from someone in your university.

Costs need to be approved.



Worktribe

All School of Mathematics (Lead) Jean Golding Institute				
SummaryDetailsPartnersBudgetRisk AssessmentPeer ReviewDocumentsBenefitsSplitComments				
Budget (Initial) Funder Filter				
	Cost to HEI	Cost to Funder	Price to Funder	Surplus/- Deficit
Directly Incurred - Staff				
Staff	£821,901.47	£698,315.87	£558,652.70	£-263,248.77
Fellow line to generate correct estates and indirects (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Fellows salary - Juliette Unwin (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£307,625.86	£277,584.47	£222,067.58	£-85,558.28
Fellows salary - school commitment (School of Mathematics) (ZUniversity of Bristol (Institutional Commitment))	£46,457.78	£0.00	£0.00	£-46,457.78
Junior researcher 1 (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£57,583.46	£53,422.30	£42,737.84	£-14,845.62
Junior researcher 2 (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£59,940.14	£53,422.30	£42,737.84	£-17,202.30
Senior researcher (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£279,170.91	£251,126.60	£200,901.28	£-78,269.63
Software Engineer (Jean Golding Institute) (MRC)	£71,123.32	£62,760.20	£50,208.16	£-20,915.16
Temp Staff	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Research Studentship Stipends	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Partner Costs	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Sub-total:	£821,901.47	£698,315.87	£558,652.70	£-263,248.77
Directly Incurred - Non Staff				
Travel and Subsistence	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Consumables	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Equipment	£1,664.25	£1,500.00	£1,200.00	£-464.25
NHS Computer (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£1,664.25	£1,500.00	£1,200.00	£-464.25
Research Facilities	£10,971.42	£9,888.60	£7,910.88	£-3,060.54
GPUs - 3000 GPUhrs for 4 years (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£9,221.16	£8,311.08	£6,648.86	£-2,572.30
Online data storage - 3TB each for 4 years (School of Mathematics) (MRC)	£1,750.26	£1,577.52	£1,262.02	£-488.24
Biological Services - Purchase	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00
Biological Services - Maintenance	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00	£0.00

Submission

- At universities, you need to submit around a week before the funder deadline so the university / submitting organisation has time to check everything.
- Often you press submit and it gets sent to somebody else in the university / submitting organisation to finally submit.

Review process

Reviews

Your review is often sent out to expert reviewers

You can sometimes suggest / ask for some reviewers not to review proposal

Sometimes you get a chance to respond to reviewers

- UKRI written response
- Wellcome forms part of interview

Interviews

Some grants make final decision based on interview.

Most interviews start with a short presentation – ranged from 3-10 mins.

Some funders give you a list of questions before you are interviewed (UKRI)



Any questions?